The _prefix option adds a status_ prefix to the generated model methods. Try calling the method status_draft? on a Vehicle Reservation instance. You can instantiate model instances and call methods on them from bin/rails console.

To see all of the possible values for the enum, refer to the db/structure.sql file.

A benefit of using the enum as a column type is that it is now reusable for other tables. Another benefit of the enum is that it can be queried with only database access and without code access to see all possible values that a column could contain. This serves as a form of documentation for other users of your database that might not have code access.

In the article *PostgreSQL: ENUM is no Silver Bullet*,[15] many examples of common enumerated types are listed along with their trade-offs.

The post *Enums vs Check Constraints in Postgres*,[16] encourages skipping Enums entirely and using CHECK constraints with an explicit list of values to check against.

In this chapter you've seen how to use Check Constraints and Database Enums.

PostgreSQL has even more concepts for constraining values. In the next section, you'll look at how to use Domains which go beyond the limitations of Enums and Check Constraints.

Sharing Domains Between Tables

PostgreSQL provides another object type called Domains[17] which have some similarities to both Enums and Constraints. In the post *Enforcing a Set of Values*,[18] storing values as table rows, as an enum, or as a Domain are compared.

The Domain that's created is a Text type, and uses a CHECK constraint ensuring the value is one from an explicit list of values. The Domain name is then used as the column type on a table.

From psql, try creating a Domain by copying and pasting the following SQL statement for the Rideshare database.

sql/create_domain.sql

```
CREATE DOMAIN vehicle_statuses AS TEXT
```

15. https://medium.com/swlh/postgresql-3-ways-to-replace-enum-305861e089bc
16. https://www.crunchydata.com/blog/enums-vs-check-constraints-in-postgres
17. https://www.postgresql.org/docs/current/sql-createdomain.html
18. https://justatheory.com/2010/01/enforce-set-of-postgres-values/